

Festival, pico and cepstral (www.cephstral.org/raspberrypi).

eSpeak produces good-quality English speech. It uses a different synthesis method from other open source text to speech (TTS) engines and sounds quite different. It is perhaps not as natural or smooth, but its articulation is clearer and easier to listen to for long periods.

```
$> sudo apt-get update
$> sudo apt-get upgrade
$> sudo apt-get install alsa-utils
```

Edit /etc/modules file to include the following line beside its other lines:

```
$> sudo nano /etc/modules
snd_bcm2835
```

Save nano with ctrl+o and then exit with ctrl+x.

```
$> sudo reboot
```

This command will reboot Raspi.

Complete the installation by adding the following software:

```
$> sudo apt-get install mplayer
$> sudo apt-get install espeak
$> sudo apt-get install espeak-gui
```

To learn about the manual of eSpeak, use:

```
$> man espeak
or
$> espeak --h
```

The last command will give you detailed options about how to use eSpeak. Before testing eSpeak, attach an amplifier with Raspi audio socket, as the normal audio output does not have enough power to drive more than an earphone. By running espeak-gui, you can pick the voice of your choice for the eSpeak synthesiser.

Given below are a few examples:

```
$> espeak "Hello Guys, welcome to EFY"
// male voice
$> espeak -ven+f3 "Hello, Welcome to EFY" // female voice
$> espeak -ven+f3 -k9 -a150 -a200 "Hello Guys, Welcome to EFY" //high pitched, well spaced, maximum amplitude female voice
```

Now, run Python program lift-light-with-espeak.py and it will speak up those floor numbers bypassing the

EFY Note

The source code of this project is included in this month's EFY DVD and is also available for free download at source.efymag.com

MP3 files.

```
$> sudo python lift-light-with-espeak.py
```

This Python program will work in a similar way, but it would not need MP3 files and the voice quality is pretty good. To run it at boot level, add it in /etc/rc.local file. ●



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